# *Rhapidophyllum hystrix*

## Needle palm, porcupine palm

Also known as: Blue palmetto | Family: Arecaceae

Beltline: 16 | Rockery: 4 | **TOTAL 20**



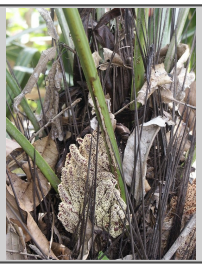
HABIT

Not available

FALL

Not available

LEAF





FLOWER / FRUIT

## QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Palm

**Evergreen or deciduous**
Evergreen clumping palm with short, thick trunk covered in sharp black needles 6–10 in long. Large fan-shaped leaves, dark green above, silvery below, to about 3 ft across. Flowers inconspicuous. Fruit small reddish-brown. Considered the most cold-hardy palm. Spreads slowly by suckers to form dense clumps. Valued for tropical appearance in temperate gardens. net

**Growth & Size**
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–6 ft tall (occasionally to 8 ft); 4–8 ft wide. Slow-growing, clumping habit

**Sun**

**Water**

**Soil**
Prefers organically rich, moist, well-drained soil. Tolerates wet soils and drought once established

**Zone 8a**
One of the hardiest palms, reliably hardy in Zones 6–10. Well suited to Atlanta Zone 8a; protect from winter winds in colder microclimates

## ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

**Origin**
Native to the southeastern United States: South Carolina, Georgia, Florida, Alabama, Mississippi. Occurs in mesic hammocks and ravine bottoms

**Form**
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**Foliage**
Not stated

**Flowers and fruit**
Not stated

**Bark**
Not stated

## PLANTING NOTES

### Siting
Not stated

### Soil prep
Not stated

### Depth & spacing
Not stated

### Best planting season
Not stated

### Establishment
Plant in part shade on rich, moist soil. Mulch in winter in colder sites. Propagate by suckers or seed (slow germination). Avoid root disturbance when transplanting

## HEALTH

### Health
No serious pest or disease problems stated. Sharp needles can injure people and animals. Endangered in the wild; purchase only cultivated plants

### Symptoms
None stated